

Student Article: Why Soil Conservation Matters in Agriculture

Soil is one of the most important resources in agriculture. Farmers depend on healthy soil to grow crops and raise livestock. However, soil erosion caused by wind and water can wash away valuable topsoil, making it harder for crops to grow. When topsoil is lost, farms may produce less food and require more fertilizers to maintain yields.

Many experts believe that soil conservation practices are essential for long-term farming success. Practices such as cover cropping, no-till farming, and planting windbreaks help keep soil in place and protect it from erosion. These methods also improve soil health by increasing nutrients and retaining moisture.

While some farmers worry that conservation practices take extra time or money, supporters argue that protecting soil now helps farms remain productive in the future. By preventing erosion, farmers can sustain their land and continue producing food for years to come.

They Say / I Say Chart

They Say (Author's Ideas)	Evidence from the Text	I Say (My Thinking)
What does the author believe about soil conservation?		
What problem is the author explaining?		
What solutions does the author suggest?		